Sorabji's endeavour to foster trade and industry in these parts. Sorabji could also be called a pioneer in 'selling' a bank to the public as opposed to merely running it, and never tired of explaining what the bank could do for the small entrepreneur and farmer. All efforts were made to convert an unsatisfied customer into a satisfied one. Sorabji's philosophy is best expressed in his own words: 'It is not gold we crave; it is the trust and goodwill of the clients that we value most.'[2]

The Central Bank had already entered the Bombay Clearing House and had applied for entry into the Calcutta Clearing House. This was refused and a special charge was levied on the collection of local cheques drawn on the bank with a view to restricting the competition. It required the intervention of Sir Norcot Warren, then Secretary and Treasurer of the Bank of Bengal, who used his good offices to persuade the Calcutta banks to stop collecting commission on local cheques. Thus, the Central Bank achieved another 'first' by becoming the first bank under Indian management to penetrate the barriers of the Bankers' Clearing House in Calcutta. But this was not the end of the opposition faced by the bank. It had started discounting bills at its Calcutta branch in 1916 to which the Bank of Bengal strenuously objected. Sorabji sought an interview with Sir Norcot but was refused on two occasions. He was lucky the third time and succeeded in convincing Sir Norcot that the Central Bank had no intention of starting a price war by undercutting rates in discounting of bills. Sorabji's personality, charm, and persuasiveness succeeded in winning over Sir Norcot and the two parted as friends.

From its earliest days, the Central Bank had displayed a proclivity to expand. The subscribed capital was increased from ₹20 lakhs to ₹30 lakhs in the latter half of 1912, the new issue of 20,000 shares of ₹25 paid-up having being taken up at a premium of ₹5 per share. The premium of ₹1 lakh was credited to the Reserve Fund. In 1917, the subscribed capital was increased to ₹50 lakhs and two years later to ₹1 crore. Both the interests of the depositors and the proliferation of branches in various parts of the country called for a higher volume of capital. Sorabji knew that it was the insufficiency of capital which had been the undoing of many Indian banks and insisted on safeguards which would enable the bank to meet any contingency. In the years 1917–22 deposits had increased four-fold from ₹3.57 crores to ₹13.22 crores by the end of 1922. In 1923, the